

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Consumption Dashboard Operations

Monitor Copilot Credit consumption, usage concentration, and spending-policy limits

Document Property	Value
Section	Operate
Audience	FinOps, Insights Analysts, Managers, Microsoft 365 Global Administrators
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Reference view, not the billing system of record

The Consumption Dashboard helps identify consumption patterns and limits that may need attention. Its credit information is **for reference only**. Reconcile official Copilot Credit billing and detailed charges in the **Microsoft 365 admin center**; reconcile GitHub AI credit charges in **GitHub.com**. Do not use a dashboard total as an invoice, chargeback ledger, or contractual entitlement record.

Table of Contents

- 1. Purpose and Current Coverage
- 2. Access and Scope
- 3. Prerequisites and Availability Checks
- 4. Operating the Dashboard
- 5. Export and Reconciliation
- 6. Success Criteria

7. Troubleshooting and Escalation

8. Dated Microsoft Learn Sources

1. Purpose and Current Coverage

The Consumption Dashboard is one of the six current Copilot Analytics areas documented by Microsoft. It is intended for operational monitoring: identify active users, review credit usage over time, see which services and employee groups drive usage, understand whether consumption is concentrated among a small number of users, and find spending policies whose users are near their limits.

Question	Use the dashboard for	Do not infer
Who is using covered services?	Active users and sessions for the selected month-to-date scope	All Copilot or agent activity across every Microsoft product
Where are credits being consumed?	Trends and breakdowns by covered service, group, organization, or job function	Invoice-level allocation or final chargeback
Is usage concentrated?	Usage-intensity segments and per-user/per-session averages	Whether high usage is productive, wasteful, or anomalous without business context
Which policies need attention?	Users and policies near or at displayed limits	That the dashboard configures, changes, or guarantees enforcement of a spending policy

Current Microsoft 365 services coverage is narrow

As Microsoft’s Consumption Dashboard article states (last updated 8 September 2026), consumption data on the **Microsoft 365 services** page is currently available only for **Copilot Cowork** and the **Work IQ API**. Its active-user and session cards use activity from those services. Microsoft’s export article lists ServiceName examples beyond these two services (Researcher, BizChat, Deepwork, Outlook and WXP). The two articles are not reconciled, so check the ServiceName values in your own export rather than assuming only Cowork and Work IQ API rows. Absence of other Copilot, Copilot Studio, or agent usage is not evidence that no such activity occurred.

The dashboard introduction also describes visibility for **Copilot Credits and GitHub AI Credits**. Keep the data boundary explicit: Insights Analyst queries with consumption metrics exclude GitHub data, and official GitHub AI credit charges remain in GitHub.com.

Page	What it covers	Notes

Microsoft 365 services	Active users, credit usage trends, service breakdown, usage intensity and spending-policy limits	Data currently only for Copilot Cowork and the Work IQ API
Cowork (Deep dive from the Cowork service breakdown)	Detail on Copilot Cowork usage and the Copilot Credits consumed through Cowork. See Cowork Dashboard Operations	Cowork tasks and Cowork sessions measure different activity, so do not compare them directly
GitHub (public preview; turned on in Privacy settings)	Active GitHub Copilot users and total AI credits for GitHub Copilot, with chat-request, code-completion, model, language and chat-mode breakdowns	Excluded from consumption queries and the export. Data before 10 July 2026 might be under-reported. On days 28–31 of the month it shows the previous 28 days

2. Access and Scope

Role	Dashboard access	Scope	Consumption queries
Insights Analyst with global partition access	Yes	Entire organization	Yes, for consumption metrics; GitHub data excluded
Manager enabled through Manager settings	Yes	Manager's group	No
Microsoft 365 Global Administrator	Yes	Entire organization	No
Insights Analyst with only a non-global partition	No	None	No
Copilot Dashboard or Agent Dashboard viewer without a role above	No automatic access; see the delegation callout below for Combined access delegates	None	No

Delegation: Microsoft's articles disagree

Microsoft's articles disagree. How to use the Consumption Dashboard says access **can't currently be delegated**. Delegate access describes a **Combined access** delegate scope that includes the Consumption Dashboard. Test in the tenant before relying on either, and review existing delegates' scopes: if the delegator has both company-level and group access, existing "Your company" delegates automatically become Combined access and might see the Consumption Dashboard. Until then, assign the least-privileged supported role and scope instead.

An Insights Administrator manages analyst access by adding or removing the analyst from the **global partition**. Removing that access also removes the analyst from every other experience in that global partition. Managers are controlled through **Manager settings**; consumption insights are enabled for all managers by default unless the setting is changed. Granting managers Consumption insights requires that they also have Copilot insights access, and the minimum team size must be at least five.

Identification. Copilot Analytics outputs are de-identified by default. Identification lets authorised users see named employees ("identified outputs"), and Microsoft lists it for the Consumption Dashboard insights and data export. Access is governed by a dedicated Viva feature access management (VFAM) policy, which only a

Microsoft 365 Global Administrator or an AI Administrator can create and manage. Agree the purpose, recipients and retention before enabling it.

3. Prerequisites and Availability Checks

Check	Expected state	Owner
Supported identity	User is a global-partition Insights Analyst, enabled manager, or Microsoft 365 Global Administrator	Global Administrator / Insights Administrator
Scope source	Manager hierarchy and employee attributes resolve for the intended population	Insights Administrator / org-data owner
Covered activity	Copilot Cowork or Work IQ API activity exists in the current month	Service owner
Privacy threshold	Manager group is large enough for insights; the service breakdown matrix additionally requires a manager of managers with a sufficiently large group	Insights Administrator
Official billing access	FinOps can compare the dashboard with the Microsoft 365 admin center or GitHub.com	Billing / GitHub administrator

GCC, preview, and tenant rollout validation

Microsoft's Supported environments matrix lists availability feature by feature for GCC Moderate (GCC-M) and GCC High (GCC-H). The Agent Dashboard, Copilot Dashboard metric export, the Consumption Dashboard and the Copilot Dashboard Readiness page are not available in either. Delegate access to dashboards is not available in GCC-M and is partial in GCC-H. Of the Copilot Power BI templates, only the Copilot business impact report is supported (GCC-M: yes; GCC-H: partial). Check the matrix for each feature before planning a government-cloud rollout.

For this guide, the matrix lists the Consumption Dashboard (all pages and features) and the consumption query as available in Worldwide only, and the export as public preview in Worldwide only. None of them is available in GCC-M or GCC-H (the matrix has no DoD column). The Consumption Dashboard article does not label the dashboard itself as preview, but the GitHub page and the export are public preview. The Copilot Studio licensing article states that Copilot Studio is available in GCC, which does **not** establish that this dashboard is available there. For any tenant where the feature is absent, validate the tenant UI, Message Center and service plan, and escalate unresolved eligibility questions to Microsoft Support.

4. Operating the Dashboard

Step 1 — Open Insights and confirm scope

Open the Viva Insights web app and select the **Consumption Dashboard**. Confirm the scope before interpreting any value:

- **Company** is available only to global-partition Insights Analysts and Microsoft 365 Global Administrators.
- **Group** limits the view to the manager's group.
- **Organization** and **Job function** use the same employee-attribute sources as the Copilot Dashboard.
- **Time period** is currently month to date.

Organization can be derived from Microsoft Entra ID or uploaded organizational data. Job function depends on the corresponding uploaded organizational attribute; a missing field can produce an empty or incomplete filter.

Step 2 — Read the summary cards

Metric	Operational meaning	Validation question
Active users	Unique users who took at least one action in Copilot Cowork or the Work IQ API	Did covered activity occur in this scope during the current month?
Total Copilot credit usage	Credits consumed by covered activity in the selected scope	Does the direction align with the official billing view, allowing for scope and timing?
Total session count	Copilot Cowork or Work IQ API sessions initiated by users	Did a rollout, campaign, integration, or automation change session volume?

On the Microsoft 365 services page, select **Deep dive** next to **Cowork** to open the Cowork page. Cowork tasks and Cowork sessions measure different activity, so do not compare them directly. See Cowork Dashboard Operations.

Step 3 — Analyze trends and service drivers

Use the trend controls to change the plotted metric, break it down by group, organization, or job function, and choose the available date granularity. Then use the service breakdown to identify which covered service and

employee segment account for the largest share. Treat this as a prioritization signal, then validate against service ownership and business context.

Step 4 — Review usage intensity

Usage intensity shows whether consumption is broadly distributed or concentrated. Review these segments:

- All users
- Top 1 percent of users
- Top 5 percent of users
- Top 6–25 percent of users
- Top 26–50 percent of users

For each segment, compare total credits, average credits per user, average credits per session, average sessions per user, and active users. A concentrated distribution is a prompt to investigate workload design, automation, value, and policy fit; it is not by itself evidence of misuse.

Step 5 — Review spending-policy limits

Use the spending-policy table to identify the top policies in use, average credits used per user, the displayed spending limit, and the number of users near or at that limit. Microsoft defines “near or at” as users who have used at least 90 percent of the credits allowed by their spending policy limit; spending policy limits are set in the Microsoft 365 admin center and reset on the first day of each month. Contact the policy owner before users are depleted. The dashboard reports the condition; policy configuration and capacity enforcement occur in the relevant administration and billing surfaces.

Capacity has contractual and service consequences

Copilot Studio documentation states that purchased capacity is enforced monthly, unused Copilot Credits do not carry over, and exceeding purchased capacity can lead to technical enforcement and service denial. Confirm the applicable licensing model, included usage, zero-rated scenarios, and current terms in the official licensing and Copilot Credit guides before taking purchasing or enforcement action.

5. Export and Reconciliation

The Consumption Dashboard export is a **public-preview** feature for user-level AI cost metrics. Personal identifiers are hashed unless an administrator has enabled **identifiable export** for you, in which case the export also includes identifiable fields. It is currently available to **Insights Analysts with global partition access** and **Microsoft 365 Global Administrators**. Microsoft’s articles differ on manager export: the export article says data export for managers “will be available by the end of July” (a date that has passed), while the Manager settings article says managers granted Consumption insights can access team-scoped data in the dashboard “and export data”. Treat manager export as unconfirmed and validate it in your tenant. The export does **not** include GitHub metrics.

Export	Window and freshness	Use
Export by week	Complete data for the previous five months plus month-to-date data for the current month; activity is usually 2–8 days behind	Weekly and monthly trend review or longer-term planning
Export by day	Start of the previous month through the export date; activity is usually up to two days behind	Day-to-day cost review and emerging usage trends

Only complete days or weeks are included. Each download is a ZIP containing two CSV files joined by `PeopleHistoricalId` :

- `PersonServiceCreditsMetrics.csv` — one row per person, service, and date, with hashed person ID (or identifiable fields when identifiable export is enabled), service, policy, sessions, limits, credits, licence status, and join key.
- `PeopleMetadata.csv` — one row per person, with the join key plus Organization and Job function where available.

The credit file includes both licensed and unlicensed users. Analysts can also pull the data directly with Power BI’s Get Data tool; for multi-table output queries, supply the Table Name parameter along with the Partition ID and Query ID. See [Create a custom consumption query](#).

- At the top right of the dashboard, select the **download** button.
- Select **Export by week** or **Export by day** and allow the ZIP download to complete.
- Record the export type, timestamp, complete-period boundary, service coverage, role, and source URL.
- Keep both CSVs together and join only on `PeopleHistoricalId` . Treat the identifier (hashed, or identifiable if enabled) and HR attributes as protected data.

5. Check that the services and population match the documented export fields; do not silently blend them with broader Copilot or GitHub activity.
6. Reconcile Copilot Credit totals against the Microsoft 365 admin center. Reconcile GitHub AI credits separately in GitHub.com; they are not in this export. Document scope, timing, and coverage differences rather than forcing the figures to match.

Do not substitute the Copilot Dashboard export

The separate Copilot Dashboard export is a public-preview user-level usage export (de-identified by default) with week-level and day-level options. It answers adoption questions; it is not the Consumption Dashboard export and is not an official billing record.

6. Success Criteria

Before operationalizing a recurring review, verify all of the following:

- The expected role can open the dashboard and sees only the documented company or group scope.
- A manager cannot switch to Company scope.
- A non-global partition analyst cannot open the dashboard or run consumption-metric queries.
- Covered Cowork or Work IQ API activity produces month-to-date users, sessions, and credits after processing.
- Organization and job-function filters return the expected population and change the totals coherently.
- Usage-intensity totals reconcile internally and do not exceed the selected population.
- Displayed spending-policy limits are confirmed with the policy owner.
- The export completes, carries the expected scope, and is stored under appropriate access controls.
- The official billing surface remains the source of record, with any discrepancy documented.

7. Troubleshooting and Escalation

Symptom	Likely cause	Action
Dashboard is absent	Unsupported role, analyst lacks global partition, manager disabled, or feature not available in the tenant/cloud	Verify the access table, global partition membership, Manager settings, tenant UI, and Message Center.
Company scope is absent	User is a manager	Expected behavior. Managers receive group scope only. Microsoft's articles disagree on delegation (see the delegation callout above), so confirm in the tenant before promising company scope.
Values are zero or unexpectedly low	No current-month Cowork/Work IQ API activity, processing delay, filters, or users on the unified exclusion list	Clear filters, confirm covered service activity and date, then compare with the source service. Do not use unrelated Copilot activity as the test.
Organization or job function is blank	Missing, stale, or low-quality organizational attributes	Validate Entra and uploaded org data, then allow the documented processing cycle before retesting.
Service-by-group matrix is absent	User is not a manager of managers or the group is below the required size	Verify hierarchy and group size; use supported summary views instead.
Consumption query is unavailable	User is not a global-partition Insights Analyst	Use the dashboard, or have the Insights Administrator assess least-privileged global partition access. GitHub data remains excluded.
Dashboard and invoice differ	Reference-only dashboard, different scope/coverage/timing, or billing adjustments	Use the official billing surface as authoritative and document the discrepancy.
Export is missing or fails	Feature availability, role, browser download, or transient service issue	Reconfirm eligibility, retry once, test another supported browser/network, and capture the error before escalation.

Escalation evidence

Before escalating, capture:

- Tenant and cloud environment, user role, and whether the analyst has global partition access
- Manager setting and expected group size, where relevant
- Dashboard URL, selected scope and filters, month-to-date boundary, and covered service
- Timestamp, screenshot, exact error text, and export behavior
- Expected Cowork or Work IQ API activity and the official billing comparison
- Any relevant Message Center or Service Health advisory

Route access, partition, manager-setting, and org-data issues to the **Insights Administrator**; role and tenant-policy issues to the **Microsoft 365 Global Administrator**; billing differences to the **billing or GitHub administrator**; and unresolved feature, cloud, or data-processing issues to **Microsoft Support**.

8. Dated Microsoft Learn Sources

Source	Last updated	Used for
Copilot Analytics introduction	1 July 2026	Six-area capability map and Consumption Dashboard audience
How to use the Consumption Dashboard in Insights	8 September 2026	Roles, scope, the delegation statement, filters, coverage, usage intensity, policy limits, and billing caveat
Export AI cost metrics from the Consumption Dashboard	8 September 2026	Preview roles, daily/weekly windows, GitHub exclusion, and ZIP/CSV data shape
Export Copilot metrics from the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard	15 July 2026	Boundary between the separate adoption export and consumption operations
Licensing for agents powered by the standard harness (Copilot Studio)	3 August 2026	Copilot Credits, monthly enforcement, no rollover, zero-rated usage, GCC statement, and source-of-truth caveats

Source discipline

Microsoft may change coverage, licensing, roles, interfaces, and cloud availability. Revalidate the dated sources and the tenant before each material process or business decision.

9. What to Read Next

Document	Use it for
Billing Operations	Licensing models, lifecycle events, capacity, and chargeback controls
Programmatic Reporting Options	Choose dashboard export, Advanced queries, Graph APIs, or audit data
Tools & Reporting Options	Find reusable validation and reporting journeys
Troubleshooting Guide	Resolve wider Copilot Analytics access and data issues

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